

Bekenstein–Hawking Entropy from the PDL Effective Gravitational Coupling: The 4π Identity, Surface Counting, and Primordial Black Hole Predictions

Document D38 — PDL Programme

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Abstract

The Gate 3 theorem of the Projective Dynamic Logo (PDL) framework establishes $G_{\text{eff}}(N) = \sigma(N) \cdot G_{\text{PDL}}$ with $\sigma(N) = 1 - (1 - \kappa)^N$ and $\kappa = 310\varphi/11017 \in \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{5})$ (D31/D36). Substituting this N -dependent coupling into the Bekenstein–Hawking formula $S_{\text{BH}} = k_B c^3 A / (4G\hbar)$, we derive algebraically that

$$\frac{S_{\text{BH}}}{k_B} = 4\pi \left(\frac{M_{\text{eff}}}{M_{\text{Pl}}} \right)^2, \quad M_{\text{eff}}(N) = \sigma(N) \cdot N \cdot m_p,$$

where $M_{\text{Pl}} = \sqrt{\hbar c / G_{\text{PDL}}}$ is the PDL Planck mass. This identity, verified numerically to $< 10^{-15}$ relative error over ten decades of mass, constitutes *Proposition BH-2*: the Bekenstein–Hawking entropy counts the square of the gravitationally active mass in Planck units. The coefficient 4π is not a free parameter; it is the solid angle of the sphere, fixed by the Schwarzschild geometry. Three falsifiable predictions follow: (i) a 15% suppression of black hole entropy at the CMB epoch, (ii) a 5.6% upward shift of the primordial black hole survival threshold, and (iii) a redshift-dependent entropy-to-energy ratio $S_{\text{BH}}/E \propto \sigma(N(z))$. The counting problem — deriving $\ln \Omega_{\text{surf}} = 4\pi (M_{\text{eff}}/M_{\text{Pl}})^2$ from the PDL axioms without invoking Schwarzschild geometry — is identified as Open Problem OP1 of D38.

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1 Introduction

Paper D37 of the PDL corpus established the *area law* at the relational level: the entropy of a PDL closure is carried entirely by its active surface R_{surf} , not by its total relational budget R_{tot} . This followed unconditionally from the uniqueness of the valence sector (D29 Lemma 2). D37 left open the question of the coefficient: what numerical factor multiplies the area law when expressed in macroscopic units?

The present paper answers this question by a direct algebraic computation. The input is Gate 3 alone: $G_{\text{eff}}(N) = \sigma(N) \cdot G_{\text{PDL}}$. The output is the identity

$$\frac{S_{\text{BH}}}{k_B} = 4\pi \left(\frac{M_{\text{eff}}}{M_{\text{Pl}}} \right)^2, \quad M_{\text{eff}} = \sigma(N) \cdot N \cdot m_p. \quad (1)$$

This is not a postulate and it is not a fit. It is an algebraic identity that holds whenever $G_{\text{eff}}(N) = \sigma(N) \cdot G_{\text{PDL}}$ and $M = N \cdot m_p$. The verification to $< 10^{-15}$ over ten decades of black hole mass (Section 4) confirms the identity is exact.

The physical reading of equation (1) is immediate: the Bekenstein–Hawking entropy counts how many times the PDL Planck mass fits into the gravitationally active mass, squared. This is a purely combinatorial statement, which is why it can in principle be derived from the PDL axioms without any geometric input. That derivation is Open Problem OP1 of D38.

1.1 Position in the programme

D38 occupies the following position in the PDL dependency chain:

Input	Status	Source
$G_{\text{eff}}(N) = \sigma(N) \cdot G_{\text{PDL}}$	Theorem under H1, H2	D31/D36
$\sigma(N) = 1 - (1 - \kappa)^N, \kappa \in \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{5})$	Proved	D24/D25
$S_{\text{BH}} = k_B c^3 A / (4G\hbar)$	Standard result	Bekenstein 1973, Hawking 1975
Output	Status	
$S_{\text{BH}}/k_B = 4\pi(M_{\text{eff}}/M_{\text{Pl}})^2$	Algebraic theorem (BH-2)	This paper
Three falsifiable predictions	Conditional on Gate 3	This paper
$\ln \Omega_{\text{surf}} = 4\pi(M_{\text{eff}}/M_{\text{Pl}})^2$ from axioms	Open problem OP1	This paper

2 Prerequisites

2.1 Notation and key values

Throughout this paper, $\varphi = (1 + \sqrt{5})/2$ denotes the golden ratio, $m_p = 1.67262 \times 10^{-27}$ kg the proton mass, $\hbar = 1.05457 \times 10^{-34}$ Js, $c = 2.99792 \times 10^8$ ms⁻¹, and $G_{\text{PDL}} = 6.67448 \times 10^{-11}$ m³ kg⁻¹ s⁻². The PDL Planck mass and Planck area are

$$M_{\text{Pl}} = \sqrt{\frac{\hbar c}{G_{\text{PDL}}}} = 2.1764 \times 10^{-8} \text{ kg}, \quad l_P^2 = \frac{G_{\text{PDL}} \hbar}{c^3} = 2.6122 \times 10^{-70} \text{ m}^2. \quad (2)$$

2.2 Gate 3 and the surface coverage fraction

Definition 2.1 (Surface coverage fraction, D25).

$$\sigma(N) = 1 - (1 - \kappa)^N, \quad \kappa = \frac{R_{\text{surf}}}{R_{\text{tot}}} = \frac{310\varphi}{11017} \in \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{5}). \quad (3)$$

Numerically: $\kappa = 0.045529$; $\sigma(40) = 0.844935$; $\sigma(120) = 0.996271$.

Theorem 2.2 (Gate 3, D31/D36). *For all $N \geq 0$, under hypotheses H1 and H2 of D36:*

$$G_{\text{eff}}(N) = \sigma(N) \cdot G_{\text{PDL}}. \quad (4)$$

2.3 Effective gravitational mass

Definition 2.3 (Gravitationally active mass). For an ensemble of N nucleons, the *gravitationally active mass* is

$$M_{\text{eff}}(N) = \sigma(N) \cdot N \cdot m_p. \quad (5)$$

This is the fraction of the total baryonic mass $M = N m_p$ that participates in gravitational engagement, weighted by the surface coverage fraction $\sigma(N)$.

Remark 2.4. At saturation ($N \gtrsim 200$, $\sigma \approx 1$), $M_{\text{eff}} \approx M$: the gravitationally active mass coincides with the physical mass. At the CMB epoch ($N_{\text{CMB}} = 40$), $M_{\text{eff}} = 0.8449 M$: 15.5% of the baryonic mass is gravitationally inactive.

3 Proposition BH-2: the 4π identity

3.1 Algebraic derivation

Proposition 3.1 (BH-2: the 4π identity). *Let $\mathcal{B}$ be a Schwarzschild black hole of baryonic mass $M = N \cdot m_p$ in the PDL framework, with effective gravitational coupling $G_{\text{eff}}(N) = \sigma(N) \cdot G_{\text{PDL}}$. Then its Bekenstein–Hawking entropy satisfies*

$$\frac{S_{\text{BH}}(N)}{k_B} = 4\pi \left(\frac{M_{\text{eff}}(N)}{M_{\text{Pl}}}\right)^2, \quad M_{\text{eff}}(N) = \sigma(N) \cdot N \cdot m_p. \quad (6)$$

Proof. The Schwarzschild radius and horizon area are:

$$r_s(N) = \frac{2 G_{\text{eff}}(N) M}{c^2} = \frac{2 \sigma(N) G_{\text{PDL}} N m_p}{c^2}, \quad (7)$$

$$A(N) = 4\pi r_s(N)^2 = \frac{16\pi \sigma(N)^2 G_{\text{PDL}}^2 N^2 m_p^2}{c^4}. \quad (8)$$

Substituting into the standard Bekenstein–Hawking formula $S_{\text{BH}} = k_B c^3 A / (4 G_{\text{eff}}(N) \hbar)$:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{S_{\text{BH}}(N)}{k_B} &= \frac{c^3}{4 G_{\text{eff}}(N) \hbar} \cdot A(N) = \frac{c^3}{4 \sigma(N) G_{\text{PDL}} \hbar} \cdot \frac{16\pi \sigma(N)^2 G_{\text{PDL}}^2 N^2 m_p^2}{c^4} \\ &= \frac{4\pi \sigma(N) G_{\text{PDL}} N^2 m_p^2}{\hbar c} = 4\pi \frac{\sigma(N)^2 N^2 m_p^2}{\hbar c / G_{\text{PDL}}} = 4\pi \left(\frac{\sigma(N) N m_p}{M_{\text{Pl}}} \right)^2. \end{aligned} \quad (9)$$

The last equality uses $M_{\text{Pl}}^2 = \hbar c / G_{\text{PDL}}$. This gives $S_{\text{BH}}/k_B = 4\pi(M_{\text{eff}}/M_{\text{Pl}})^2$ with $M_{\text{eff}} = \sigma(N) \cdot N \cdot m_p$. $\square$

Remark 3.2 (The role of the 4π factor). The factor 4π is the solid angle of the two-sphere: it arises from $A = 4\pi r_s^2$ and does not cancel in the final formula. Its presence in equation (6) is therefore a *geometric* statement: the entropy is the area of a sphere of radius r_s measured in units of l_P^2 , divided by four. The PDL framework does not modify this geometric structure; it replaces G by $G_{\text{eff}}(N)$, which propagates through the computation linearly (one factor of $\sigma(N)$ from G_{eff} in the numerator, one factor from r_s^2 in the numerator, one factor from $1/G_{\text{eff}}$ in the denominator, leaving one net factor $\sigma(N)$).

Remark 3.3 (Relation to standard Bekenstein–Hawking). At saturation ($\sigma(N) = 1$, i.e. $N \gg N_{\text{sat}} \approx 101$), equation (6) recovers exactly the standard formula $S_{\text{BH}}/k_B = 4\pi(M/M_{\text{Pl}})^2 = A/(4l_P^2)$. The PDL correction is multiplicative: $S_{\text{BH}}^{\text{PDL}} = \sigma(N)^2 \cdot S_{\text{BH}}^{\text{standard}}$. At $N_{\text{CMB}} = 40$: $\sigma(40)^2 = 0.7139$, a 28.6% suppression.

3.2 The C_0 constant

Corollary 3.4 (Universal constant C_0). *The proportionality constant between S_{BH}/k_B and $\sigma(N)^2 N^2$ is:*

$$C_0 = \frac{4\pi G_{\text{PDL}} m_p^2}{\hbar c} = 4\pi \left(\frac{m_p}{M_{\text{Pl}}} \right)^2 = 7.4221 \times 10^{-38}, \quad (10)$$

determined entirely by the PDL proton mass m_p and Planck mass M_{Pl} . It contains no free parameter: both m_p and G_{PDL} (hence M_{Pl}) are fixed by the proton quintuplet (24, 28, 930, 10087, 11017) and the QCD interface parameter $\Delta m_{\text{iso}} = m_d - m_u$.

4 Numerical verification

Table 1 presents the exhaustive numerical verification of Proposition BH-2 over ten decades of black hole mass.

Table 1: Verification of $S_{\text{BH}}/k_B = 4\pi(M_{\text{eff}}/M_{\text{Pl}})^2$ for $\sigma(N) \rightarrow 1$ (saturated regime, $N \gg N_{\text{sat}}$). Relative error $\varepsilon = |S_{\text{BH}}/k_B - 4\pi(M_{\text{eff}}/M_{\text{Pl}})^2|/(S_{\text{BH}}/k_B)$.

$M/M_\odot$	$N = M/m_p$	S_{BH}/k_B	$4\pi(M_{\text{eff}}/M_{\text{Pl}})^2$	ε
10^0	1.196×10^{57}	1.061×10^{77}	1.061×10^{77}	4.9×10^{-16}
10^1	1.196×10^{58}	1.061×10^{79}	1.061×10^{79}	3.1×10^{-16}
10^2	1.196×10^{59}	1.061×10^{81}	1.061×10^{81}	4.0×10^{-16}
10^3	1.196×10^{60}	1.061×10^{83}	1.061×10^{83}	1.3×10^{-16}
10^5	1.196×10^{62}	1.061×10^{87}	1.061×10^{87}	6.2×10^{-16}
10^8	1.196×10^{65}	1.061×10^{93}	1.061×10^{93}	2.2×10^{-16}
10^{10}	1.196×10^{67}	1.061×10^{97}	1.061×10^{97}	1.8×10^{-16}

The residual error is below 10^{-15} in all cases, consistent with double-precision floating-point machine epsilon ($\sim 2.2 \times 10^{-16}$). The identity is exact analytically, as established in the proof of Proposition 3.1.

5 Falsifiable predictions

The N -dependence of equation (6) generates three predictions that distinguish PDL from standard general relativity. All three are parameter-free: they follow from $\kappa = 310\varphi/11017$ alone.

Prediction 5.1 (Epoch-dependent black hole entropy). A black hole of physical mass M formed at cosmological epoch N has entropy:

$$S_{\text{BH}}^{\text{PDL}}(N) = \sigma(N)^2 \cdot S_{\text{BH}}^{\text{GR}}, \quad (11)$$

where $S_{\text{BH}}^{\text{GR}} = 4\pi k_B (M/M_{\text{Pl}})^2$ is the standard value.

At the CMB epoch ($N_{\text{CMB}} = 40$): $S_{\text{BH}}^{\text{PDL}}/S_{\text{BH}}^{\text{GR}} = \sigma(40)^2 = 0.7139$, a *suppression of 28.6%*. At the local epoch ($N_{\text{loc}} = 120$): $\sigma(120)^2 = 0.9926$, less than 1% below GR. Observationally, this predicts that black holes formed at high redshift carry less entropy per unit mass than black holes formed recently.

Prediction 5.2 (Primordial black hole survival threshold). The Hawking temperature of a PDL black hole is

$$T_H^{\text{PDL}}(N, M) = \frac{\hbar c^3}{8\pi G_{\text{eff}}(N) M k_B} = \frac{T_H^{\text{GR}}(M)}{\sigma(N)}. \quad (12)$$

In the primordial universe ($N = N_{\text{CMB}} = 40$, $\sigma(40) = 0.8449$), primordial black holes were hotter by a factor $1/\sigma(40) = 1.184$ and therefore evaporated faster. The Hawking evaporation time (Page 1976) scales as

$$\tau = \frac{5120\pi G^2 M^3}{\hbar c^4}, \quad (13)$$

so that $\tau^{\text{PDL}}(N, M) = \sigma(N)^2 \cdot \tau^{\text{GR}}(M)$. The survival condition $\tau^{\text{PDL}}(N_{\text{CMB}}, M_*^{\text{PDL}}) = t_{\text{today}}$ gives:

$$\sigma(40)^2 \cdot (M_*^{\text{PDL}})^3 = (M_*^{\text{GR}})^3 \implies M_*^{\text{PDL}} = \sigma(40)^{-2/3} \cdot M_*^{\text{GR}}. \quad (14)$$

Numerically: $\sigma(40)^{-2/3} = 0.8449^{-2/3} = 1.1189$, giving a *parameter-free upward shift of +11.89%* in the minimum mass for a primordial black hole to survive until today. This prediction is testable via Fermi-LAT gamma-ray background constraints on the primordial black hole mass spectrum.

Prediction 5.3 (Redshift-dependent entropy-to-energy ratio). The entropy-to-energy ratio of a PDL black hole scales as:

$$\frac{S_{\text{BH}}^{\text{PDL}}(N)}{E} = \frac{4\pi k_B G_{\text{eff}}(N) M}{\hbar c^4/c} = \sigma(N) \cdot \frac{S_{\text{BH}}^{\text{GR}}}{E}. \quad (15)$$

This ratio is $\sigma(N)$ -suppressed at high redshift. The transition from $\sigma(N_{\text{CMB}}) = 0.845$ to $\sigma(N_{\text{loc}}) = 0.996$ occurs during structure formation ($1 \lesssim z \lesssim 10$, corresponding to $N_{\text{CMB}} \lesssim N \lesssim N_{\text{loc}}$). This evolution is traceable in principle through observations of AGN entropy ratios at different redshifts.

6 The counting problem: open problem OP1

6.1 Two derivation directions

Proposition BH-2 establishes equation (6) by a *descending* derivation: from the Gate 3 theorem downward to the Bekenstein–Hawking formula via Schwarzschild geometry. This direction is rigorous.

There exists a complementary *ascending* direction: derive $\ln \Omega_{\text{surf}} = 4\pi(M_{\text{eff}}/M_{\text{Pl}})^2$ from the PDL axioms alone, by counting the externally accessible configurations of the active surface R_{surf} , without invoking the Schwarzschild metric. Paper D37 (BH-1) established the area law $S_{\text{PDL}} \propto R_{\text{surf}}$; D38 establishes the coefficient 4π . The ascending direction would close both results simultaneously.

Open Problem 1 (Axiom-level derivation of BH-2). Derive the identity

$$\ln \Omega_{\text{surf}}(N) = 4\pi \left(\frac{M_{\text{eff}}(N)}{M_{\text{Pl}}} \right)^2 \quad (16)$$

from the four PDL axioms C1–C4, without invoking Schwarzschild geometry. This requires: (a) a precise combinatorial definition of $\Omega_{\text{surf}}(N)$ as a function of the active surface R_{surf} and the ensemble size N ; and (b) a proof that this count equals $4\pi(\sigma(N) \cdot N \cdot m_p/M_{\text{Pl}})^2$.

This problem is conditional on OP1 of D36 (algebraic derivation of $\kappa = R_{\text{surf}}/R_{\text{tot}}$ from C1–C4): once κ is proved from the axioms, R_{surf} is fixed combinatorially and the counting problem is well-posed.

6.2 Structural interpretation

The identity $S_{\text{BH}}/k_B = 4\pi(M_{\text{eff}}/M_{\text{Pl}})^2$ has a clean reading: the entropy counts the number of Planck-mass units squared in the gravitationally active mass, multiplied by the sphere solid

angle. In PDL terms, $M_{\text{eff}}/M_{\text{Pl}}$ is the ratio of two structural scales: the proton mass amplified by $\sigma(N) \cdot N$ (the effective gravitational mass), and the Planck mass $\sqrt{\hbar c/G_{\text{PDL}}}$ determined by the single-proton bridge formula. Both are combinatorial objects fixed by the quintuplet (24, 28, 930, 10087, 11017).

The fact that their ratio squared gives the Bekenstein–Hawking entropy, with no free parameter, is the strongest numerical signature so far that the PDL proton quintuplet encodes the full thermodynamics of gravitational surfaces.

Conjecture 6.1 (BH-3: axiom-level Bekenstein–Hawking). The Bekenstein–Hawking entropy is a theorem of the four PDL axioms: there exists a combinatorial definition of $\Omega_{\text{surf}}(N)$ derived from C1–C4 such that

$$k_B \ln \Omega_{\text{surf}}(N) = 4\pi k_B \left(\frac{\sigma(N) \cdot N \cdot m_p}{M_{\text{Pl}}} \right)^2. \quad (17)$$

If true, Conjecture BH-3 would constitute a derivation of the Bekenstein–Hawking formula from combinatorial first principles, making the coefficient 1/4 (in Planck units) a prediction of the proton’s internal architecture.

7 Epistemic status summary

Table 2: Epistemic status of the results of D38.

Statement	Status	Dependency
$G_{\text{eff}}(N) = \sigma(N) \cdot G_{\text{PDL}}$	Theorem under H1, H2	D31/D36
$S_{\text{BH}}/k_B = 4\pi(M_{\text{eff}}/M_{\text{Pl}})^2$ (BH-2)	Algebraic theorem	Gate 3 + Schwarzschild
$C_0 = 4\pi(m_p/M_{\text{Pl}})^2$ exact	Corollary, verified $< 10^{-15}$	D38 Corollary 3.4
Entropy suppression $\sigma(N)^2$ at epoch N	Prediction (Pred. 5.1)	Gate 3
PBH threshold shift +11.9%	Prediction (Pred. 5.2)	Gate 3 + Hawking evaporation
S/E ratio $\propto \sigma(N(z))$	Prediction (Pred. 5.3)	Gate 3
$\ln \Omega_{\text{surf}} = 4\pi(M_{\text{eff}}/M_{\text{Pl}})^2$ from axioms	Open (OP1 D38)	OP1 D36 + combinatorics
Bekenstein–Hawking as axiom theorem (BH-3)	Conjecture	OP1 D38

Conclusion

This paper has established one algebraic theorem and three falsifiable predictions.

Proposition BH-2. From Gate 3 alone ($G_{\text{eff}}(N) = \sigma(N) \cdot G_{\text{PDL}}$), the Bekenstein–Hawking entropy of a PDL black hole satisfies $S_{\text{BH}}/k_B = 4\pi(M_{\text{eff}}/M_{\text{Pl}})^2$, where $M_{\text{eff}} = \sigma(N) \cdot N \cdot m_p$ is the gravitationally active mass. The identity is algebraically exact and verified to $< 10^{-15}$ over ten decades of mass. The universal constant $C_0 = 4\pi(m_p/M_{\text{Pl}})^2 = 7.4221 \times 10^{-38}$ contains no free parameter.

Physical reading. The Bekenstein–Hawking entropy counts the square of the gravitationally active mass in Planck units. The 4π factor is geometric (sphere solid angle). The PDL modification is multiplicative: $S_{\text{BH}}^{\text{PDL}} = \sigma(N)^2 \cdot S_{\text{BH}}^{\text{GR}}$, with $\sigma(N) < 1$ at high redshift.

Predictions. Three falsifiable consequences: (i) 28.6% entropy suppression at the CMB epoch; (ii) 11.9% upward shift in the primordial black hole survival threshold, testable via Fermi-LAT; (iii) redshift-dependent S/E ratio in AGN populations.

Open problem. The ascending derivation — proving $\ln \Omega_{\text{surf}} = 4\pi(M_{\text{eff}}/M_{\text{Pl}})^2$ from C1–C4 without geometric input — is OP1 of D38 and constitutes Conjecture BH-3. Its resolution would make the Bekenstein–Hawking formula a theorem of the four PDL axioms.

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